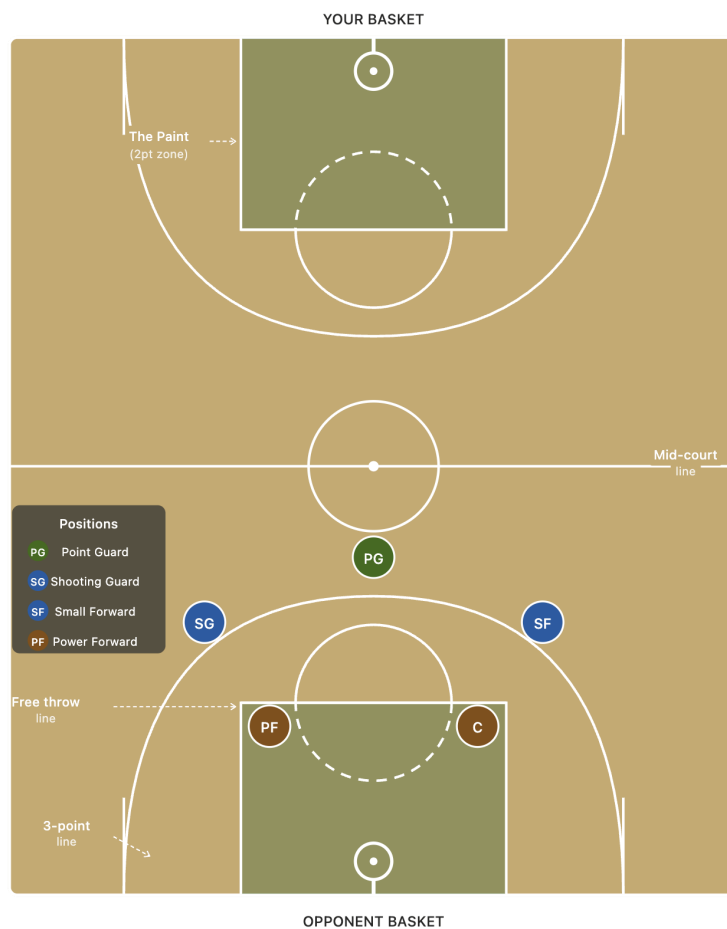


Basket Ball Basics for Beginners



Let me walk you through the key zones:

The Paint (green zone) -> the rectangular area right under the basket. This is where centers and power forwards live. Most 2-point shots happen here. It's called "the paint" because it's literally painted a different color on real courts.

The Free Throw Line -> where players stand for free throws. Notice it's at the top edge of the paint, about halfway between the basket and mid-court.

The 3-Point Line -> the curved arc. Any shot made from outside this line is worth 3 points. Inside it is worth 2. This is why position matters so much for your dataset analysis — guards shoot from outside the arc, big men shoot inside it.

Mid-Court Line -> divides the court in half. Once your team crosses this line with the ball, you can't go back or it's a turnover.

The 5 Positions — shown on the bottom half (team's offensive end):

- Green (PG) sits at the top, furthest from the basket — controls the ball
- Blue (SG + SF) on the wings — shooters and scorers
- Orange (PF + C) closest to the basket — rebounders and rim protectors

This is exactly why in the dataset we'll see **Centers have high BLK and TRB** (they're right under the basket) while **Point Guards have high AST** (they control the ball at the top). The court position explains everything!

Basketball is Just a Possession Game

Every single moment in basketball, one team has the ball and one team doesn't. The whole game is really just about:

GET the ball → SCORE with the ball → DON'T lose the ball

That's it. Every stat in your dataset fits into one of those 3 phases.